

McFarlin silent on resignation rumor

Rumors have surfaced around UTEP that Miner baseball coach Larry McFarlin may resign following the 1980 season. However, McFarlin refuses to comment on the subject.

McFarlin said Thursday he had "no comment" on the report that he would leave the university.

"We're getting ready for WAC (Western Athletic Conference play)," McFarlin said, "and that's the most important thing right now."

UTEP Athletic Director Jim Bowden also had little comment on the matter, saying, "I haven't seen a report (resignation). He didn't tell me this would be his last season."

UTEP's baseball future is clouded by the lack of a playing field, as construction crews will bulldoze the Campus Field to begin work in May on a new business college building.

Asked what the university's plans are for replacing the field, Bowden said: "You'll have to talk to the president's office about a new field. I'm not familiar with what they're doing."

There has been speculation for several years that land behind Rudolph Chevrolet on Sun Bowl Drive would be converted into a new baseball park. The land is currently owned by the city.

"Personally, I feel like an airplane that doesn't have a runway to land on," said McFarlin concerning the fact that UTEP does not have a field to play its 1981 non-conference games on. "Where are you going to go?"

McFarlin was upset when the Miners were unable to play a scheduled double-header against New Mexico State Monday at Dudley Field because the field was unplayable.

An El Paso Parks and Recreation Department official called Bowden Friday asking if UTEP could get an alternate field for Monday's games. Bowden apparently gave his approval.

McFarlin was in Albuquerque at the Turquoise Tournament when he was told Dudley Field would not be available.

Were he to resign, McFarlin can return to the El Paso Public School System. He was a teacher and baseball coach at MacArthur Intermediate School before replacing Andy Cohen as Miner baseball coach in 1978.

Earlier this season, McFarlin said he was unhappy because he was not spending enough time with his family.

"My family comes first and finances second and with no money in my pockets, it's getting tough on my family," McFarlin said.